

CHRO Survey 2019

WELCOME TO THE 2019 CHRO SURVEY!

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in consultation with the following CHROs:

The survey should take between 15 and 30 minutes, and you are free to quit at any point in the survey. Once all results are reviewed and analyzed, a copy of the study results will be sent to all respondents.

Instructions: The purpose of this survey is to assess how today's CHROs allocate their time among competing demands and identify their challenges. Our hope is to provide CHROs with data regarding key leverage points which will increase their effectiveness, particularly regarding interfaces with the Board of Directors.

This year we focus on board assessment practices, building and onboarding ELT members, and corporate culture, including the board's knowledge and involvement. Many CHROs have asked about the impact of new C-Suite members (particularly CEOs) on the cohesiveness and performance of the executive leadership team. **All answers are confidential, and are seen only by the researchers administering the survey.** No data will be released that is not aggregated across all of the respondents. Quotes from open-ended questions will never be attributed to individuals. Any potentially identifying information will be stripped before use.

Please answer the questions to the best of your ability. **However, to save time, please feel free to skip questions where you do not feel you have any particular insights or are not comfortable answering.** On the open ended questions, we request that you provide enough detail to ensure that we know what you mean. For example, instead of "identifying talent" you might be more specific and say "identifying the right executive level talent", or "making sure we have enough bench strength among our executive team". If you have any questions, please contact **Patrick Wright** at patrick.wright@moore.sc.edu.

Section 1: **CHRO and HR Demographics:**

Questions 1-3 refer to the demographic characteristics of you, the respondent.

Q1 Age

Q2 Gender

Male

Female

Q3 Race

White

Black or African American

Asian

Hispanic or Latino

American Indian or Alaska Native

Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

Other (please specify)_____

Q4. How many full time HR employees does your company have?

Q5. What is the budget for your HR department?

☐ \$ _____

Your Role as Chief Human Resource Officer - When you are answering questions, you will be able to see percentages calculated at the bottom to ensure that you do not exceed 100%.

Q6. Over the course of an average fiscal year, what percentage of your time would you say you spend in each of the following roles?

Strategic Advisor to the Executive Team (activities focused specifically on the formulation and implementation of the firm's strategy): : _____ (1)

Counselor/confidant/coach to the Executive Team (activities focused on counseling or coaching executive team members or resolving interpersonal or potential conflicts among team members): : _____ (2)

Liaison to the Board of Directors (preparation for Board meetings, phone calls with Board members, attendance at Board meetings): : _____ (3)

Talent Strategist/Architect (activities focused on building and identifying the human capital critical to the present and future of the firm): : _____ (4)

Leader of the HR Function (working with HR team members regarding the development, design and delivery of HR services): : _____ (5)

Workforce Sensor (activities focused on identifying workforce engagement/morale issues or concerns and building employee engagement): : _____ (6)

Representative of the Firm (activities with external stakeholders, such as government agencies, investor groups, proxy advisory firms, professional societies, etc.): : _____ (7)

Other - Please specify : _____ (8)

Total : _____

Q6a. If the categories listed above do not describe how you spend your time or if there is substantial overlap in categories, please provide clarification or context.

Q7. A new model of the CHRO Role has been developed by a number of CHROs. We would like to get a sense of how you allocate your time across these newly identified roles. **Over the course of an average fiscal year, what percentage of your time would you say you spend in each of the following roles?**

Functional business leader – Creating a financially disciplined team to run the HR function: _____

Business acumen/analysis – Participating in business reviews, operational reviews, etc.: _____

Business strategy development – Shaping and influencing the company's strategy to move the organization forward: _____

Board's leader of human capital – Support CEO succession, executive compensation, and responses to external trends: _____

Creator of talent strategy – Manage talent development and direct workforce planning: _____

Enterprise change leader – Plan for enterprise changes, manage stakeholders, and advocate for employees: _____

Driver of culture and purpose – Link strategy to culture, measure and communicate culture, and hold leadership accountable for culture: _____

Trusted advisor and coach – Coach the CEO, manage the executive leadership team, and develop key enterprise talent: _____

Q7a. **If the categories listed above do not describe how you spend your time or if there is substantial overlap in categories, please provide clarification or context.**

Section 2: The Executive Leadership Team

Q8. How many executives directly report to the CEO? _____

Q9a. Of the CEO's direct reports, how many are:

	Women	Men
White		
Black or African American		
Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish		
Asian		
American Indian, Alaska Native, or Pacific Islander		
Middle Eastern or North African		
Other		

Q9b. How many ELT members were newly placed in their positions in 2018?_____

Q10. How much time does the CEO commit to the development of the ELT (not counting time in "staff" meetings)? _____

Q11. How often does the CEO meet with all of his or her direct reports collectively?

- Weekly
- Every 2 weeks
- Monthly
- Quarterly
- Every 6 months

Q12. How often does the CEO formally meet with each of the following direct reports (e.g., scheduled, face to face, on a regular cycle)?

	Almost daily	Weekly	Biweekly	Monthly	Quarterly	N/A – not a position on the ELT
Chief Operating Officer / President						
Chief Financial Officer						
Chief Human Resource Officer						
Chief Marketing Officer						
Chief Legal Officer						
Chief Information Officer						
Business Unit Leaders						
Other Leaders						

Q13. How often does the CEO informally meet with each of the following direct reports (e.g. informal, impromptu, or reactive meetings)?

	Almost daily	Weekly	Biweekly	Monthly	Quarterly	N/A – not a position on the ELT
Chief Operating Officer / President						
Chief Financial Officer						
Chief Human Resource Officer						
Chief Marketing Officer						
Chief Legal Officer						
Chief Information Officer						
Business Unit Leaders						
Other Leaders						

Q14. What financial resources do you dedicate to the development of the C-Suite team? ____

Q15. What activities or processes do you use to ensure an aligned executive team?_____

Q16. Do you perform external benchmarking for C-Suite positions?

Q16a. Which positions? How often?

Q17. Do you consider board members as potential non-CEO C-suite successors?

Yes

No

Q18. Do you use assessment centers for C-suite positions?

Yes

No

Q19. How likely are successors for each of the CEO's direct reports to come from within the firm?

	Extremely unlikely	Unlikely	Neither unlikely or likely	Likely	Extremely Likely	N/A – not a position on the ELT
Chief Operating Officer / President						
Chief Financial Officer						
Chief Human Resource Officer						
Chief Marketing Officer						
Chief Legal Officer						
Chief Information Officer						
Business Unit Leader 1						
Business Unit Leader 2						
Business Unit Leader 3						
Other 1						
Other 2						
Other 3						
Other 4						
Other 5						
Other 6						
Other 7						

Q20. How deep is the current INTERNAL pipeline to fill each of the CEO's direct report's?

	0	1	2-3	4-6	7-9	10+
Chief Operating Officer / President						
Chief Financial Officer						
Chief Human Resource Officer						
Chief Marketing Officer						
Chief Legal Officer						
Chief Information Officer						
Business Unit Leaders						

Q21. Please describe the extent to which you agree with the following statements about the Executive Leadership Team (ELT).

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
There is a great deal of trust among members of the ELT					
Members of the ELT work together as a team					
The members of the ELT are cooperative with each other					
ELT members know that they can depend on each other					
The members of the ELT stand up for each other					
The members of the ELT regard each other as friends					
The ELT has a climate for healthy debate					
On our ELT, everyone's ideas for how to do things better are given serious consideration					
ELT members believe that problem-solving is improved when input from all members is considered					
ELT members engage in productive debates in an effort to improve decision making					
ELT members feel they can reveal their true selves without being threatened					
The ELT is committed to ensuring executives can resolve conflicts effectively					
ELT members are valued for who they are as people, not just their role as executives					
ELT members often share and learn about one another as people					
The ELT has a culture in which members appreciate the differences other members bring to the company					

Section 3: CEO Succession

Q22. Thinking about where you currently are in regards to succession planning, how effective has the Board been at...

	Not a current activity the board performs	Extremely ineffective	Worse than average	Average	Better than average	Extremely effective
Defining and taking ownership of the process						
Identifying strategic challenges the next CEO will face						
Identifying competencies necessary to meet future strategic challenges						
Identifying and evaluating successor candidates						
Developing successor candidates						
Other 1 - please specify						

Q23. How did the CEO get promoted into their current role?

	Internal	Direct external hire	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)
CEO (CEO)			

Q24. How did the CFO, and you (the CHRO) get promoted into their current role?

	Internal (from within function)	Internal (from different function)	Direct external hire	Indirect external hire (hired with the expectation of promotion in less than 24 months)
CFO (CEO)				
CHRO (CFO)				

Qxx. Who on the board has responsibility for the ongoing CEO succession planning process (when no succession event has been defined or is imminent)?

No entity has formal responsibility
Compensation committee (or equivalent)
Nominating and governance committee (or equivalent)
Chairman of the board or Lead director
Other

Qxx. Who on the board has responsibility for CEO succession planning as an event approaches / is imminent (e.g. transition timing has been defined, CEO has left office)?

No entity has formal responsibility
Compensation committee (or equivalent)
Nominating and governance committee (or equivalent)
Chairman of the board or Lead director
Other

Section 4: Board of Directors

*****If your company does not have a board of directors or similar/equivalent governing body, please select the third or fourth option and you will skip the remaining questions.**

Q25. Please select the response that best describes your company

A public company with a board of directors

A private company with a board of directors or an equivalent group

A private company with no board or equivalent

Other (please specify) _____

Q26. Does your company's CEO also serve as Chairman of the Board (or its equivalent)?

Yes, the CEO serves as the Chairman of the Board **AND** we have a lead director. (4)

Yes, the CEO serves as the Chairman of the Board **AND** we **DO NOT** have a lead director. (5)

No, the CEO **DOES NOT** serve as the Chairman of the Board. (6)

Q27. How many members comprise your board of directors?

_____ Number of board members (11)

Q28. Does your board have female directors?

Yes

No

BRANCH, if yes: Q28a: How many current directors are women? _____

Q28b: What are the unique challenges that female directors face in the board room?

BRANCH, if no: Q28c: Are you trying to attract female directors?

Yes

No

Branch, if yes: Q28d: What are the challenges your board faces with recruiting or attracting female directors?

Q29. Based on your observations of and interactions with the board, please describe the extent to which you agree with the following statements about the Board.

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
There is a great deal of trust among members of the Board					
Members of the Board work together as a team					
The members of the Board are cooperative with each other					
Board members know that they can depend on each other					
The members of the Board stand up for each other					
The members of the Board regard each other as friends					
On our board, director input is actively sought from all members					
The board has a climate for healthy debate					
On our board, everyone's ideas for how to do things better are given serious consideration					
Board members believe that problem-solving is improved when input from all members is considered					
Directors engage in productive debates in an effort to improve decision making					
Directors feel they can reveal their true selves without being threatened					
The board is committed to ensuring directors can resolve conflicts effectively					
Directors are valued for who they are as people, not just their role as director					
Directors often share and learn about one another as people					
The board has a culture in which directors appreciate the differences other directors bring to the board room					

Commented [PW1]: I would add these questions to the ELT part as well

Q30. Over the course of an average fiscal year, of the time you spend with the Board, what percentage of your time would you say that you spend working with the Board of Directors (or its equivalent) on the following?

Executive Pay Issues: : _____ (1)

CEO Succession Issues: : _____ (2)

CEO Performance Issues: : _____ (3)

Other Senior Executive Talent/Succession Issues: : _____ (4)

Other Senior Executive Performance Issues: : _____ (5)

Ethics/Compliance/Governance Issues: : _____ (6)

Risk Management: : _____ (7)

Activist Investors: : _____ (8)

Other - Please Specify : _____ (9)

Total : _____

Q30a. If the categories listed above do not describe how you spend your time or if there is substantial overlap in categories, please provide clarification or context.

Section 5: Board and ELT Assessment

We are interested in learning more about the processes that boards and executive leadership teams use to evaluate their processes and members.

Q31. Does your board of directors formally assess its performance, relationships, processes, etc. on a regular basis?

Yes, via internal processes

Yes, using a third party

Yes, using a mix of internal processes and third party help

No

Q32. For each of the following assessment methods, please indicate the means by which such an assessment is performed (check all that are used) and how often such an assessment is performed.

	Survey	Interview	Other	Annually	Every 2 years	Every 3 years	Other
Director self assessment							
Director assessment of other individual directors							
Director assessment of board processes / workings							
CEO / ELT assessment of the board							
Other (please specify):_____							

Q33. BRANCH BASED ON RESPONSES TO PRIOR QUESTION – IF YES TO SELF ASSESSMENT OR ASSESSMENT OF INDIVIDUAL DIRECTORS: When assessing performance of individual directors, are members assessed on the following topics?

	Yes	No
Knowledge of the company		
Knowledge of the industry		
Engagement in meetings		
Preparedness		
Impact on board culture (e.g. dialogue, diversity, ethics)		
Strategy and risk taking		
Support / counseling / advice to the CEO		
Communication with other directors on the board		
Relationship with other directors		

Q34. BRANCH IF BOARD CONDUCTS ASSESSMENT OF GROUP: When considering performance of the board as a group, is the board assessed on the following topics?

	Yes	No
Appropriateness of time spent with the company (e.g. number and length of meetings)		
Board member knowledge and capability mix		
Board's openness of communication and acceptance of director ideas		
Board culture		
Delegation of work to committees		
Oversight of committees		
Monitoring of management succession planning		
Monitoring of the company's risk strategy and risk appetite		
Holding senior management accountable		
Overseeing and managing executive compensation		
Monitoring the industry's technological trends and developments		
Oversight of the strategic planning process		
The board's relationship with management		
The board's relationship between members		

Q35. Does ELT formally assess its performance, relationships, processes, etc. on a regular basis?

Yes, via internal processes

Yes, using a third party

Yes, using a mix of internal processes and third party help

No

Commented [SD2]: In terms of building the highest performing ELT...?

Commented [SD3]: If the answer to this is no, follow up with a question about if they would see value in doing this.

Open ended on why are you not doing this?

If they do it, how effective is it? If they don't do it, how effective might it be?

Q36. For each of the following assessment methods, please indicate the means by which such an assessment is performed (if it is used) and how often such an assessment is performed.

	Survey	Interview	Other	Annually	Every 2 years	Every 3 years	Other
Executive self assessment							
Executive assessment of other ELT members							
Executive assessment of ELT processes / workings							
Board assessment of the ELT processes / relationship							
Other (please specify): _____							

Q37. **BRANCH:** When considering performance of the ELT as a group, is the ELT assessed on each of the following topics?

	Yes	No
Appropriateness of time spent as a leadership team (e.g. number and length of meetings)		
ELT knowledge and capability mix		
ELT's openness of communication and acceptance of ideas		
ELT culture		
Delegation of work to individual ELT members		
Executive succession planning		
The company's risk strategy and risk appetite		
Holding ELT members accountable		
Monitoring the industry's technological trends and developments		
The strategic planning process		
The ELT's relationship with the board		
The ELT's relationship between members		

Section 6: Organizational Culture

Q38. We are also interested in understanding how the board and executive leadership team manage the organization's culture. First, consider the degree to which each of the following statements are true regarding the board's knowledge, understanding, and interest in the organization's culture.

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
The board takes ownership of our culture					
The board is knowledgeable about our company culture					
The board has a strong understanding of the company's culture					
The board is interested in our company's culture					
Compared to 24 months ago, the board is paying more attention to our company's culture.					

Q39. Based on your interactions with the board, the board believes that culture helps in...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
Avoiding enterprise risks					
Engaging and retaining employees					
Enhancing company financial performance					
Implementing strategic initiatives					
Aligning organizational members					
Branding the organization					
Other: _____					

Q48. As a CHRO, how do you have discussions with the board on culture?

Share engagement survey

Share formal culture assessment

Have formal discussion about the organization's culture without data

Other

Q49. In what ways has the board's view of, and focus on, culture changed in recent years?

Q40. Next, consider the degree to which each of the following statements are true regarding the CEO's knowledge, understanding, and interest in the organization's culture.

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
The CEO takes ownership of our culture					
The CEO is knowledgeable about our company culture					
The CEO has a strong understanding of the company's culture					
The CEO is interested in our company's culture					
Compared to 24 months ago, the CEO is paying more attention to our company's culture.					

Q41. Based on your interactions with the CEO, the CEO believes that culture helps in...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
Avoiding enterprise risks					
Engaging and retaining employees					
Enhancing company financial performance					
Implementing strategic initiatives					
Aligning organizational members					
Branding the organization					
Other: _____					

Q47. As a CHRO, how do you assist the CEO with regards to the company's culture?

Q50. In what ways has the CEO's view of, and focus on, culture changed in recent years?

Q42. Next, consider the degree to which each of the following statements are true regarding your (the CHRO's) knowledge, understanding, and interest in the organization's culture.

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
I, the CHRO, take ownership of our culture					
I am knowledgeable about our company culture					
I have a strong understanding of the company's culture					
I am interested in our company's culture					
Compared to 24 months ago, I am paying more attention to our company's culture.					

Q43. I believe that culture supports the organization in:

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
Avoiding enterprise risks					
Engaging and retaining employees					
Enhancing company financial performance					
Implementing strategic initiatives					
Aligning organizational members					
Branding the organization					
Other: _____					

Q46. As a CHRO, what is your role in managing the organization's culture?

Q44. To what extent does your organization have a strong culture, characterized by intensely held beliefs and norms amongst a significant majority of its members?

To a very little extent

To some extent

To a moderate extent

To a great extent

To a very great extent

Q45a. On a scale of 1 to 5, indicate to what degree you would agree that each statement describes your company's culture:

The organization is focused on:

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
Collaboration and trust					
Compassion and tolerance					
Exploration and creativity					
Fun and excitement					
Achievement and winning					
Strength and boldness					
Planning and caution					
Structure and stability					

Q45b. The organization feels like:

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
A big family					
An idealistic community or cause					
A dynamic project					
A celebration					
A meritocracy					
A competitive arena					
A meticulously planned operation					
A smoothly running machine					

END OF SURVEY

Q51. Have you been through a CEO succession in the last 3 years? If yes, would you be willing to let us interview you on the following topics:

- a. How the ELT was built / altered / composed to assist the new CEO.
- b. Any best practices you may have implemented.
- c. If you have any other feedback or would like to be contacted further, please feel free to leave your name and contact information and we will contact you.